

Question:

A 5-year-old boy is brought to the physician by his mother because he does not “listen to her” anymore. The mother also reports that her son cannot concentrate on any tasks lasting longer than just a few minutes. Teachers at his preschool report that the patient is more active compared to other preschoolers, frequently interrupts or bothers other children, and is very forgetful. Last year the patient was expelled from another preschool for hitting his teacher and his classmates when he did not get what he wanted and for being disruptive during classes. He was born at term via vaginal delivery and has been healthy except for 3 episodes of acute otitis media at the age of 2 years. He has met all developmental milestones. His mother has major depressive disorder and his father has Graves' disease. He appears healthy and well nourished. Examination shows that the patient does not seem to listen when spoken to directly. The remainder of the examination shows no abnormalities. Which of the following is the most appropriate next step in treatment?

Answer Choices:

- A. Behavior therapy
- B. Methimazole
- C. Fluoxetine
- D. Hearing aids

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's symptoms include difficulty listening , inability to concentrate , hyperactivity , interrupting others , and being disruptive , which are characteristics of Attention Deficit Hyperactivity Disorder (ADHD). Additionally , the mother's mental health issues and father's thyroid condition , though unrelated to the patient's current presentation , can be considered . The most appropriate next step in treating ADHD is behavior therapy , which focuses on reinforcing positive behaviors and providing strategies for parents and teachers to manage the child's behaviors . Methimazole is used to treat hyperthyroidism , which is not relevant here . Fluoxetine is an antidepressant and is not typically used as the first-line treatment for ADHD . Hearing aids are used for hearing impairments , which the patient does not have .

</think>

<answer> A. Behavior therapy </answer>